

Examination Of Male Abuse In Selected Nollywood Films

Wokoro Silver Nnenda

Department of Theatre and Film Studies, Rivers State University,
Nkpolu-Oroworukwo. Port Harcourt
Email: wokorosilver@gamil.com

Iloma Nyenwemaduka Richard, PhD

Department of Theatre and Film Studies, Rivers State University,
Nkpolu-Oroworukwo. Port Harcourt
Email: richard.iloma@ust.edu.ng

Tekena Gsaper Mark, PhD

Department of Theatre and Film Studies, Rivers State University,
Nkpolu-Oroworukwo. Port Harcourt
Email: tekena.mark@ust.edu.ng

Abstract

Abuse is when someone causes us harm or distress. It can take many forms, ranging from disrespect to causing someone physical or mental pain. It can occur in someone's home, a hospital or a public place. Often the people who commit abuse are taking advantage of special relationship. Abuse is a widely discussed topic or idea which focuses more on the female gender or the abuse of power etc. but this research is focused on male abuse which has been rarely considered as a topic for discussion. The whole idea behind this research is to be able to discover the trauma surrounding a male child who has been abused from childhood and growing with this trauma into adulthood and the effect or consequences this can actually pose in their lives. It is against this background that this study aimed at examining male abuse in four selected Nollywood films: Penance (Biodun, 2020), Brown Skin Girl (Emelobe, 2020), Nimbe (Alake, 2019) and Echoes of Integrity (Ugezu, 2024). This study adopts the qualitative research methodology in its analysis of the Nollywood films. The theories guiding this research are: Etiology of child maltreatment: A developmental Ecological analysis in the book; Understanding Child Abuse and Neglect by Belsky Jay, published in 1993 and Social Learning Theory, a concept proposed by Canadian-American psychologist Albert Bandure in 1977. Findings show that a lot of male children/adult have suffered abuse over the years without the courage to speak up. The study therefore recommends that parent/caregiver and the society should pay attention to the male child/adult in the area of abuse.

Introduction

A child is a young person especially between infancy and puberty. To me a child is a tender being deemed unfit to make rational decision on their own. According to the United Nations Convention on the child (UNCRC), a child is “A human being below the age 18 years unless the law applicable to the child, maturity is attained earlier.” This is ratified by 192 of 194 member countries. (*Children in the military. Child slavery. Child labour; n.d.*).

To further look at the definition of a child, we say a child (plural: Children) is a human being between the stages of birth and puberty or between the developmental period of infancy and

puberty. The term may also refer to an unborn human being. In English – speaking countries, the legal definition of child generally refers to a minor, in this case as a person younger than the local age of maturity (there are exceptions like, for example the consuming and purchasing of alcohol beverage even after said age of majority), regardless of their physical, mental and sexual development as biological adult. Children generally have fewer rights and responsibilities than adults. They are generally classed as unable to make serious decisions. (*Children in the military. Child slavery. Child labour, n.d.*).

Child may also be described as a relationship with a parent (such as sons and daughters of any age) or metaphorically, an authority figure or signify group membership in a clan, tribe, place, or circumstances, as in “a child of nature” or “a child of the sixties.” (*Children in the military. Child slavery. Child labour, n.d.*).

Basically, the life of a male child/adult is the centre of this discussion, his struggle through life and re-action when hit by the circumstances of life. Male refers to “Belonging to the sex which typically produces sperm, or to the gender which is typically associated with it.” A boy is a young male human. The term is commonly used for a child or an adolescent. When a male human reaches adulthood, he is usually described as a man. There are also some qualities that are attached or visible in the character of a male child. Standard of manliness or masculinity vary across different cultures, subcultures, ethnic groups and historical periods. Traits traditionally viewed as masculine in Western society include strength, courage, independence, leadership, dominance, and assertiveness. In many societies, the male child is expected to be the breadwinner, providing for his family's need and ensuring their financial security. This expectation is rooted in the traditional gender roles where men are seen as the primary earners and women as caregivers.

The transition from boyhood to becoming a man doesn't happen automatically or overnight. Experiences, relationships, and challenges faced along the way shape each of us into unique individuals. And all of these factors help a boy turn into a man. While most males learn and grow on this journey, others do not. How a boy responds to the adversity along the way will determine if he matures or gets lost in an arrested development. Some males learn from their mistakes, seek wisdom from older adults and take the challenges that come at them head on. Let's further look at these seven characteristics that a boy child grows with into manhood.

They plan their future: Men think long term-about their relationship, career, finances, living situation and more. They aren't just winging it. Sure, they may not have it all figured out, but they have a good idea of where they want their lives to go in the next five or ten years and they are laying the foundation to get there. On the other hand, boys who are yet to become men don't have these plans and live moment to moment.

They take responsibility: Men have a lot of pressure on them these days and let's face it, we don't always get it right. Being a man means owing up to your mistake and taking responsibility for your actions, even if you are in the wrong. Boys, however, tend to make excuses rather than take responsibility.

They think about the kind of man they want to be: Men reflect on their values and morals, and what kind of person they want to be. This includes what kind of partner, father, employee and friend they are and how that matches what they want. Men have put thought into their values and lead lives that reflect them. Boys aren't sure about their moral compass just yet and don't steer their life with such intention.

They know what they want: Men who are truly men have a clear vision of what they want for their future. They know what they want in a partner, career, and in life in general. For instance, men pursue a relationship with a woman instead of chasing dates with girls.

They are decisive: Because men have a better idea of what they want, they tend to make decisions easier. They go after career opportunities that interest them and are willing to commit to a partner. They aren't afraid to make a decision because they have a clear idea of who they are and what they want.

They practice integrity: Men have integrity. They say what they mean, they show up when they said they will, and they follow through on their promises. While boys who haven't become men yet are flaky and don't follow through.

They understand what it means to pursue love: Men may be fearful of rejection, but they will still initiate conversation with a woman, knowing that the reward can be greater than the risk. They understand what it takes to seek out a woman and they muster the courage to do so. Boys may pursue for a short time, but then give up when it gets difficult.

Two males can wear the same clothing, go to the same job, and even date the same woman. On the outside, they may look similar, but after taking a closer look, it can become clear that only one is really a man, while the other is still functioning as a boy.

Having looked at all that is surrounding a male, what a child is, the attribute attached to a male child; there is one thing evident, which is the trait that all male has, this matured positive ego. A male child has this ego that they always have things in control, the ego that they always want to protect and no one should decide or try to correct them from what they feel is good or best for them.

Some of these traits that they pose are actually the problem they have as a male child, when they are faced with abuse or in the face of abuse (child/male abuse), they tend to take responsibility even as a child then grows with it into adulthood or a man, owing to responsibility and struggles with it, with the idea that they can handle it, no matter how hurt they feel. The whole idea behind this research is to be able to discover the trauma surrounding a male who have been abused from childhood and growing with this trauma into adulthood and the effect or consequences this can actually pose in their lives.

Naturally we all know that the males in general have this ego of being in control of whatever circumstances they find themselves owing to the fact that they think that complaining and not taking responsibility makes them weak, these have been inculcated in them right from childhood through the action of parent and society. For example; when a male child cries, the responds of people around him will always be "men don't cry" and even as an infant or a baby, you hear things like "this one cries like a girl" all of these are factors that contribute to the ego

that the male children grow with, and instead of speaking out, they bear it like a man, so to say. Growing with this ego as expected of you as a man (male child), so many male children in the faces of abuse will find it difficult to speak up, because the society expects them to handle things as a man, even when they are yet children. In the end, some of them is either they become violent for the abuse they have faced earlier in life or addicted to a certain way of life or traumatized for the rest of their lives and some even live with regrets for the rest of their lives etc. A lot of male children have been abused over the years with no one speaking out for them, or even themselves speaking out for the public to hear them. Some of this is as a result of the society and the expectation levied on them as a male. A child is a child whether male or female, so certain responsibilities should not be shouldered by them because the society thinks their gender is more superior. A male child (who is also a child) should not always be shouldered with the responsibility of protecting the other sibling even as a child, because in the process of taking up these responsibilities they also may be victims and because of these responsibilities before them, they feel that speaking up will make them failures, because the hero they expect of him will eventually be defeated. And also, the ego of “being in control” which is a major trait posed by the male child. Even as a child and now as an adult I have come across male children during a fight with another male, and eventually an adult comes or probably a member of the family of the child being defeated in the fight shows up, the anger that erupts in the child will be physically demonstrated by the child. There is this feeling that the members of his family or any adult need not show up for him, because he is in “control” and showing up in his time of weakness eventually pass the signal to him that he is a weak child or a failure and if eventually any one of his friend is responsible for alerting his family members or any adult to come to his rescue, that child will not hesitate to pick a fight with that friend of his immediately his separated, because he feels his friend did not give him the opportunity to prove himself. Most of this ego that the society and nature have on a male child contributes to the muteness in the face of abuse, the ego of being in charge, in control, independence, breadwinner, security, leadership, dominance, courage in the face of pain, assertiveness, to protect etc. are all contributing factors. The encouragement of male children to fight back by parents or adults because they are male, after being involved in a physical combat with a fellow male child, probably because they feel the child (boy) was defeated. Lastly parents/caregivers hardly pay attention to the male children in the area of abuse, because they ignorantly do not know that male children are also victims when it comes to abuse, so also the society have turn blind eyes to the abuse male adult receive in the hands of the female folks, but the major problem is the inability of the male folks to speak out in the face of abuse.

Synopsis of *Penance*

Stephen Biodun's *Penance* (2020) centers on a little boy, Oliver who is molested by their maid Patience for three years, from the age of ten to thirteen years. Patience mum is a friend to Oliver's mother, Patience lost her father and is sent to Kamsi's family to take care of their ten years old son in order to relief or lessen the burden on Patience mother. On the arrival of Patience, Oliver is very happy because he is a very lonely kid and the two become very fond of each other, which Patience seizes the opportunity to molest him. After three years of molestation, Oliver's parent finds out and throws Patience out of the house; returning from school Oliver could not find Patience, he cries bitterly, but his mother tells him Patience ran away. Oliver now an adult, very reserved, hardly communicates with anyone except for his only friend Elohor who has been longing to be in a romantic relationship with him, but Oliver always turns her down with no good

reason for doing so. Elohor introduces a neighbour's son Benjamin who has just returned from NYSC to work with Oliver since they both are in the same field; Computer engineering. They both bond, Oliver gets fond of Benjamin because he is a brilliant kid. Benjamin is raised in a godly way in the Catholic faith. His mother is constantly reminding him to be aware of people around him including his new boss, since Benjamin had told her that his boss, Oliver only surrounds himself with only male employees and no family member comes to visit him. On arriving Oliver's house for work during the weekend, Benjamin discovers a woman much older than Oliver, when he questions Oliver about the woman, Oliver says: she is his lover, Benjamin in shock. Surprisingly, the woman pays Benjamin a visit in Oliver's absence at the office and tries to seduce him, on Oliver's return, Benjamin expresses his disappointment towards Oliver and his kind of lifestyle, then opted to resign, Oliver would not get over Benjamin, he pays him a visit but meets his mum. On seeing Oliver, Benjamin's mum faints. Days later, Benjamin's mum pays Oliver a visit at his office and offers to help Oliver overcome his urge for older women and then opens up that she is his aunty pat(Patience), Oliver is happy and at the same time walks pat out of his office for running away and having cheated in the relationship because she has a son which is Benjamin. Patience comes home with no other choice than to tell Benjamin, after Elohor confronts her, Benjamin is devastated that he leaves the house roaming the streets all through the night. The next morning he made his way to Oliver's house to plead for forgiveness for the actions of his mother, Oliver tells him not to bother himself with such things, that it wasn't his fault, Benjamin immediately leaves; Oliver knowing whom Benjamin is, decides to go after him only to discover Benjamin telling his mum who has been crying and pleading for Benjamin's forgiveness, that he is leaving for Abuja and that he could not stand the fact that he can't have a relationship with his father Oliver because of her ungodly act. Pat didn't mention the fact that Oliver is the father to Benjamin because she wasn't sure Oliver will believe her because he was only thirteen years at the time. Oliver opens the door shock over what he has heard the both of them arguing, Benjamin walks away from the two of them in tears.

The movie *Penance* reviews some of the sexual, emotional and psychological violence male children go through as a result of abuse. In the movie *Penance*, Oliver is a victim of sexual abuse, which eventually affected him from childhood to adulthood. Even as an adult, who was abused from age ten to thirteen he still believes in the love (abuse) that existed long ago between a woman who is more than ten years older than him; after all these years he is still in search of aunty Patience in every older woman he is dating without a slightest knowledge that at that age he has been abused and that it might be the effect of the abused he received from childhood.

Examination of Male Abuse in Stephen Biodun's *Penance* (2020)

This could be portrayed in the life of Oliver as a male adult. In the movie *Penance*, the effect of sexual abuse is the dominant factor in types of abuses faced by Oliver. Sexual abuse, and the impact are all visible in the life of Oliver. Sexual abuse involves forcing a child to engage in sexual acts that they do not truly understand. Oliver did not fully understand that he was taking advantage of, to him it's normal to be having sex with an adult. From age ten to thirteen was the length of time which Oliver was actually abused, but as he grew older (adult), it had a psychological effect on him, where he is never attracted to someone close to his age, but women who are way much older with a particular body shape, that is, liking them big; complexion, light skinned, this seem to be the features of his abuser. Even when his abuser indicates interest to help him overcome his urge for older women as a way of apology for abusing him, he was very

angry, and works her out of the office insinuating he wasn't abused but in love.

The impact this abuse left in Oliver is the feeling of anger at every slightest provocation, even with business associates, for approaching him in a certain way. The impact of guilt and shame over the treatment he has endured is his unwillingness to accept he was abused, because that looks awkward to him, towards the end his friend Elohor and his councilor was able to convince him it was abuse, even when Benjamin was apologizing to him on behalf of his mother's act towards him, we could see the impact of guilt and shame all over him. Another impact visible is that of marriage/family difficulties. Oliver's inability to settle down or having a romantic relationship with Elohor his friend after countless effort by Elohor to make it come through proves abortive; this is because Oliver, even in his thirties was still looking for aunty Pat, his abuser in every woman(older) he meets. Unable to see it, hence the difficulty of getting married and having a family life becomes difficult. Depression is another effect Oliver experienced. The invisible depression Oliver went through that was not visible to anyone but Benjamin; this could be seen when Benjamin called him a sick man, after pointing to him that he has no loved ones around and no one ever comes to visit him.

Picture Illustration of *Penance*



Plate 1: Aunty Patience pays Oliver a visit at his office to discuss how she can help him overcome his urge for older women.



Plate 2: Oliver recognizes Aunty Patience, almost in tears because he misses her; then gives her a warm embrace.



Plate 3: Oliver angry with Aunty Patience for running away without telling him and because he believes she cheated on him with Mr. Ladi, the gate man, because of her son Benjamin, then walks her out of his office.



Plate 4: Oliver and Elohor in a heated argument. Elohor explains to him that at age ten, sleeping with aunty child insists it was a consensual.



Plate 5: Young Oliver and aunty Patience in a romantic mood, why heading to the bathroom to have their bath.

Synopsis of *Brown Skin Girl*

Stephen Biodun's *Brown Skin Girl* (2020), centres around a young and fast rising music star Daniel Orman, who is engaged to a light skinned girl called Clarissa. The scene opens with Orman being disappointed with meeting the lady he meant online who happens to be “light skin” in Instagram, but in physical appearance happens to be brown skinned, this gets him very angry, which eventually leads to his walking out on her. Orman returns from the studio to find his girlfriend Clarissa home, she has flown from London, but their conversation didn't end well with Orman confronting her about cheating on him with Flyboy, she admits it was before their engagement. Clarissa unable to cook and clean decides to employ the services of a housekeeper. Mo, a fashion designer and a friend of Adunni the young writer, advises Adunni to get a house cleaning job for a hundred and fifty thousand to be able to get herself a new laptop since her present one is giving her issues, at first Adunni refuses but later gives in, Mo contacts the agent and Adunni is offered the job of a house keeper at Orman's house.

Orman unaware of the new maid returns home drunk and tipsy, finds a lady on the coach hoping it is Clarissa, gets involved romantically with her, Adunni screams, Orman jumps up, on seeing Clarissa and Adunni, he faints. Orman couldn't sleep that night, he is furious with Clarissa for not giving him a heads up on the new maid and also mad at her for making him kiss the feet of a brown skinned girl, which he considers an abomination, because he will never date or love a brown skin girl (dark skin girl). Clarissa is intentional about her choice of complexion, regarding a house keeper knowing fully well Orman will never fall for someone dark, it's clear when she happily tells her friend Chelsea about the incident the previous night and that Adunni will never be a competition since Orman will never like her kind. Orman hates Adunni because of the previous incident and will always abuse her verbally including body shaming her. Orman finds out from his friend Toyo about Clarissa's recent romantic engagement with Flyboy while she was in London, rushes home, almost strangles her to death, but finally asks her to leave his house. Clarissa leaves and clearly states it to Orman that she will be back and asks Adunni to take care of her Oga and the house. Adunni finds trashed papers of Orman's rough works on music, decides to add the pieces. Adunni is off to see Mo, when Orman storms her room in search of her only to discover what Adunni did with the trashed songs. Adunni fed up with staying under the same roof with Orman returns to tell Orman that she has been paid by her Madam and has no intention of staying anymore, Orman pleads with Adunni to stay back and be his lyricist, and he promise to pay her a hundred and fifty thousand per song. Adunni refuses and packs her belongings and leaves. Adunni reconsiders the offer and returns to Orman's house with the condition that Orman will be respectful towards her and never call her names or abuse again, Orman accepts and introduces her on a life stream video online as his lyricist, this did not go down well with Clarissa who returns to the house to blackmail Adunni; Orman finds out about the supposed video for the blackmail which made him smash her phone and asks her to leave and never come back to his house again. Adunni is tired of the secret admiration she feels for Orman, which one way or another Orman will jokingly put it to her that he will never love her kind. Orman storms Mo's house in search for Adunni and discovers Mo narrating how Adunni mulches Orman's name in her sleep and her desire to be with him, Orman takes Adunni out for dinner that evening and explains how his Councilor had advised him to speak to Adunni because he had actually fallen in love with a brown skinned girl, Adunni could not believe it, until he opens up on his abuse that caused his hatred towards every brown skin girl, and that's where she falls. And there comes the happy ending for the both of them.

The movie “*Brown Skin Girl*” reviews the impact of sexual and emotional abuse given to a male child, Orman was nine years old when their house keeper/maid started abusing him, as a result of this, his life almost got ruined. The thought of loving a brown skin girl irritates him. The abuse he faced was responsible for the disruption in the brain and the believe that all brown skin girls are not good enough for him or are evil, so to say. We also find anxiety, depression, hostile behaviours and the use of alcohol as a habit which indicates the impact of emotional abuse. In the case of sexual abuse faced by Orman, it has an immediate and long-term effect on him which is seen in his feeling of anger towards brown skin girls, guilt and shame over the treatment he has endured. In the area of neglect, Orman's parents practically did not pay attention which made him display emotional and behavioural problems as a result of their abandonment.

Analyzing Male Abuse in *Brown Skin Girl*

Orman is the figure for the male adult portrayed in *Brown Skin Girl*. In the movie, the type of abuse that affected Orman is that of sexual abuse and neglect. The effect of these abuse had a negative impact on Orman, resulting to him hating every dark (brown) skin girl.

We see sexual abuse as the forceful participation of children in sexual acts. It is this forceful participation that resulted to the hate Orman has for brown skinned girls, the fight that Orman put up, in order to stop their house maid from constantly abusing him only resulted to her starving him of food that left him with no choice than live with this disgusting life style for four years of his life. We can imagine the horror he went through while he has to hate the house maid and all the features she had, which made him to transfer the same allege to every dark skin girl.

The effect or impact sexual abuse had on him was the feeling of anger; this is seen at every slightest provocation, especially with Adanni, the maid which he really was not in support of her stay in his house. Due to the hate, he has for dark skinned girls, he constantly abuses Adanni verbally even without Adanni provoking him, just by seeing her alone is enough for her to get abuses. The impact of guilt and shame affected Orman, he really never talked about it, but carried it as a burden for years, not until he was advised.

Picture Illustrations in *Brown Skin Girl*



Plate 6: Orman trying to strangle Adanni, because of his hatred towards her as a brown skin girl.

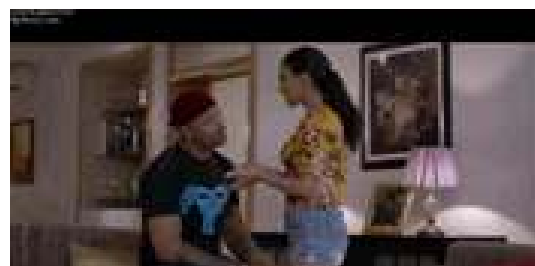


Plate 7: Orman with his cheating Plate light skinned girlfriend Clarisa.



Plate 8: Orman verbally abusing Adunni.



Plate 9: Orman abusing a girl for skin forgery over the internet, while in real life, she is a dark or brown skin.

Synopsis of *Nimbe*

Tope Alake's *Nimbe* (2019) tells the story of a teenage boy who is confronted with a very abusive father, a caring mother and parents who are always seen fighting, quarrelling without a moment of peace when they are together. The scene opens with Mr. Bayo Oguntade, Nimbe's father and Mrs. Uduak Oguntade all set to go to work, Nimbe's mum, calls Nimbe out, who is also getting ready for school, but without any need for argument or quarrel, Nimbe's father just decides to abuse Nimbe, by calling him an idiot, fool and all sorts of names. Mr. Bayo Oguntade abuses Nimbe verbally and physically at every slightest opportunity he gets, making Nimbe uncomfortable around him, Nimbe's mum on the other hand is trying her best to make Nimbe comfortable around his father and at home and also trying to be a good wife as much as she can. But Mr. Bayo Oguntade keeps making things difficult. Nimbe, an outstanding and very brilliant kid, is always bullied at school by his classmates especially one called Benji who always snatches his meals and bullies him in class. one of the days Benji and his friends ambushed him, as they were returning from school, luckily, he is saved by this strange kid called Ralph, Ralph is another kid who have been facing neglect by his parents who were never at home, nor having time for him and his sisters but always chasing their dreams. Ralph tries to get attention from his parents but to no avail, somehow, he becomes a drug addict and roam the street with some drug dealers. unlike Nimbe who had illiterate parents, Ralph's parents were educated but fails woefully in terms of giving attention. On a weekend, Nimbe is sent on an errand to buy food for his father, on returning, Benji and his friend attacks him and pour away the food, Nimbe returns to his father with an empty plate. Mr. Bayo Oguntade verbally and physically abused Nimbe, then drags him back to the street to have a street fight with Benji. Nimbe pleads with his father that he is not ready for such display. Nimbe is brutally beating by Benji, with Mr. Bayo forbidden anyone to come to his rescue, Ralph witnesses all of this. Later that evening, while Mrs. Uduak Oguntade massages Nimbe, Mr. Bayo continues with his verbal abuse towards Nimbe, he claims that Nimbe is a bastard and not his son, Mrs. Oguntade tries to calm him, but they get into an argument and starts quarrelling, Nimbe, who is lying in his mother's laps, gets up and gradually leaves the house. Nimbe is seen in a quiet and lonely place, where he draws something abstract, which expresses how he feels. Ralph joins him, introduces himself to Nimbe and offers him some mixture in a water bottle for him to drink, saying it will help him feel better; including smoking for the first time. Nimbe who had never received such kindness embraces Ralph friendship. Ralph introduces Nimbe to the street life including the drug cartel, Nimbe becomes a drug addict, and also skips school without the knowledge of his parents

Mrs. Oguntade notices Nimbe's strange behaviour and decides to trail him, only to find out Nimbe works for Ak the drug cartel leader, she immediately barged into his offices crying and begging Ak not to allow Nimbe to get involved in drug dealing. Ak who refers to Mrs. Oguntade as Auntu Uduak says he is not aware that Nimbe is her son and promised her that he will speak to Nimbe about it. Ak is displeased with Nimbe as he speaks to him about a mother's love that is special and not to be joked with. Nimbe comes home and pleads with his mother for forgiveness and promises to go back to school. Ak takes Nimbe for a mission and some of his boys to go find a snitch, after Mr. Bayo throws Nimbe and his wife, Uduak out of the house, because Uduak washed his blue jean trouser which contains his bet paper worth over 1.5 million. Mrs. Uduak Oguntade makes her way to her friend's house, while Nimbe is rejected by Ralph because Ak, the cartel leader likes and is fond of Nimbe after Peju, his little sister gave him a portrait drawing Nimbe made for him on his birthday. On Ralph's rejection, Nimbe made his way to Ak's house where he is gladly received by Peju, his new friend and Ak's younger sister. This availed Ak the closeness to Nimbe, on finding the snitch, Ak made Nimbe to kill for the first time, as he put Nimbe's hand on the trigger while his was on top of Nimbe's and then pulls the trigger. Peju who have been drugged and raped by her boyfriend, one of Ak's drug runners is pregnant for him, Peju confronts Lemon, her boyfriend about this, but Lemon advises her to go for an abortion otherwise Ak will kill him. Peju comes home bleeding as a result of the abortion, Mira, Peju's friend and Nimbe tries to help her, Ak asked Nimbe to take her to the hospital after Nimbe reached out to him on the phone on the situation at home, but Peju dies at Nimbe's and Mira's arms. Nimbe, Ak and his boys sets out to hunt lemon at night, on finding him, Ak pulls the trigger on him. Things starts falling apart, Ak and his boys are hunted and arrested by the police, Ralph on the other hand is diagnosed with liver problem and at the hospital because of the stuffs he is taking with his parents watching over him at the hospital. Mr. Bayo Oguntade realize his mistake and goes to his wife, to plead for forgiveness, Nimbe on the other hand just shot Banji in class for bullying him again after refusing to say sorry when Nimbe demanded for it, this made everyone in the school to run for their lives. Later that evening Mr. and Mrs. Oguntade set out in search of Nimbe and finds him among drug addict drinking and smoking; Mr. Bayo in shock, expresses his disappointment over Nimbe. Nimbe insists he is the disappointment, Uduak insists Nimbe comes home with them, but Nimbe tells her that where he is, amongst drug addicts is home. Nimbe is arrested for killing Raph and sent to life imprisonment.

Unlike the movies: *Penance and brown skin girl* which deals more especially with sexual abuse and its terrible impact, Nimbe is a movie with abuses like: neglect, emotional, verbal, psychological and physical abuse which finally leads to life imprisonment of a bright and outstanding teenage boy. first of all, Nimbe as a teenage kid suffers greatly from verbal abuse from an abusive father, even as brilliant as Nimbe is, his father will always refer to him as an idiot, fool, bastard, good for nothing, lazy, bad luck and a never-do-well, this led to an emotional abuse, which occurs where a child is degraded, terrorized, isolated or exploited by a parent/caregiver. This is seen where a child is constantly criticized, threatened, rejected or given no support or love while growing up. All of these emotional abuse traits was experienced by the teenage boy Nimbe from his father. Nimbe is constantly degraded, terrorized by his father, without a just cause, in the movie, Nimbe have never done anything wrong to be treated that way. Nimbe is isolated at home, in school and is been exploited in school by Benji and his gang who happens to be his classmate, always forcefully taking away his meals, books etc. When it comes to being criticized, threatened, rejected or given no support or love while growing up, Nimbe

experienced all of these by his parents, more especially his father, who abuses both Nimbe and Nimbe's mother. Nimbe was never applauded for doing well in school by his parents not until he started skipping class and doing badly in his academic work due to his involvement in drugs. When it comes to psychological and physical abuse, Nimbe's experiences were horrible, he was shamed by his father in public, beaten, humiliated etc. Nimbe's mother, Mrs. Oguntade frequently experienced abuse from her husband in front of Nimbe which resulted to the psychological abuse that Nimbe faced; each time he sees his parents quarrel, he would leave the house and go to a lonely and isolated area, staying all by himself and making up abstract sketches, including when he was abused by his father. This could be seen in one of the scenes where he was in the woods all alone, when Raph confronted him, he said he was feeling sad and the drawing he is making is as a result of how he feels. Nimbe also suffered the abuse of neglect, where his parents failed to meet his basic needs. In the open scene, we see Nimbe's mum on behalf of Nimbe requesting for just three hundred naira from Nimbe's father to get him a mathematical set, but he bluntly refused, but rather abused the hell out of him.

A Critical Evaluation of Male Abuse in *Nimbe*

In the movie *Nimbe*, Nimbe the young teenage boy is faced with negative effects of the physical, verbal, neglect and emotional or psychological abuse he got from his parents, more especially from his father, Mr. Oguntade. Physical abuse is reported as a form of abuse which refers to the deliberate physical harm of a child by parents or caregivers. Physical abuse may involve hitting a child with hands or an object, burning, biting or physically restraining a child with the intent to do harm is also considered as physical abuse. Physical abuse is always seen in a home where domestic violence is rampant. Nimbe's father is always verbally abusing and beating Nimbe's mother and he extended this domestic violence to Nimbe. The effect or impact physical abuse left on Nimbe is that of mental effect, which later leads to PTSD meaning Past Traumatic Mental Disorder. The signs visible in physical abuse faced by Nimbe is facial and body injuries and bruises. This is visible in the movie when Nimbe's father, Mr. Oguntade beats Nimbe and during the process, also forced Nimbe to engage in a fight with Benji. The verbal abuse Nimbe received from his father had an emotional impact on him, it caused a disconnection in his sense of self, it is also responsible for negative disruption in his brain, it is also responsible for the anxiety he faced, depression, low self-esteem, alcohol and drug use. the effect or impact of neglect is as a result of his parent's failure to meet his basic needs, this played out in his emotional and behavioral problems as a result of their abandonment.

The general effect abuse had on Nimbe are:

- i) Unexplained changes in behavior or personality
- ii) Becoming withdrawn
- iii) Seeming anxious
- iv) Becoming uncharacteristically aggressive
- v) Lack of social skills and has no friends
- vi) Poor bonds or relationship with parents

And the behavioral clues are:

- i) Poor concentration
- ii) Development of phobias
- iii) Display of fear among parents
- iv) Speech difficulties
- v) Poor performance at school (later)
- vi) Substance abuse

Another teenager in the movie *Nimbe*, who is also affected by the abuse of neglect was Ralph. Unlike Nimbe, his parents were well to do but were never a stay-at-home parent. They both had careers that they were chasing but gave little or no attention to Ralph a young teenager boy, even when he tries to get his father to pay attention, his father offered him money instead. The effect or impact this left with Ralph are; poor performance in school, emotional and behavioral problem as a result of their abandonment. He also had liver disease traceable to excessive alcohol and drugs, it also left him with poor bonds and relationship with parent.

Picture Illustrations in *Nimbe*



Plate 10: Mr. Oguntude, Nimbe's father verbally abusing Nimbe, because he requested for three hundred naira to by mathematical seth



Plate 11: Nimbe's father physically abusing him, for not fighting Binji, when Benji poured away the food he sent him to buy.



Plate 12: Nimbe's father setting up a fight for Nimbe and Benji, against Nimbe's wish.



Plate 13: Nimbe physically abused by his father, for allowing Binji win the fight.

Synopsis of *Echoes of Integrity*

Ugezu. J. Ugezu's *Echoes of integrity* (2024) revolve around Chiora, a public and government official, who works in the bureau of standardization of goods. Chiora is known for his hard work and integrity when it comes to fighting against corruption, he is never open to discussion when it comes to bribery. On a fateful day, one chief omeliigwe pays him a visit in his office trying to bribe him with twenty million naira in order to smuggle in fake pharmaceutical products to the state. Chiora turns him down and informs him that every pharmaceutical product in the state must be registered with NAFDAC before he can approve the distribution in the state; the rejection of this money cost him his job. it is at this point that his wife who used to be very loving and caring decides to be abusive towards him verbally. The verbal abuse that Chiora received in his home affected him by reducing his self-esteem, made him feel worthless; he is faced with discouragement for his good deeds from his wife which eventually he lost her to the same chief who tried to bribe him. Chiora is also faced with emotional abuse from his wife which was constantly degrading and criticizing him, because to her he acted foolishly for rejecting a twenty million naira offer, he was also denied support and love during this period of his agony from his wife. He also faced neglect, which is another form of abuse, the refusal of his wife to give him food which made him to start borrowing from a woman he hardly knows and selling of his personal belongings out of frustration.

A Textual Reading of Male on Abuse in *Echoes of Integrity*

In this movie, *Echoes of Integrity*, it is glaring that even as a grown male adult, male still suffer abuse silently in the hands of women, and will find it difficult to speak out due to ego attached to being a man, they feel by speaking up, they are not taking responsibility, Chiora shows courage in the face of abuse and never played the victim, suffering in silence and pretending to be in control. Some of these masculinity traits Chiora exhibited is as a result of the society and expectation levied on a male. The society expects them to be a bread winner, independent, courageous as a traditional masculinity trait but also fails to see their sufferings as humans. it is the emotional or psychological abuse that Chiora received from his wife that led to the low self-esteem visible in him all through the period he stayed without a job.

Picture Illustrations in *Echoes of Integrity*



Plate 14: Chiora's wife verbally abusing Chiora for losing his job, because he failed to compromise.



Plate 15: Chiora pleading with his wife not to leave, that hopefully he will bounce back.

A Comparative Analysis of Abuse in the Selected Films.

The four films used in this research are *Penance* (2020), *Brown Skin Girl* (2020) *Nimbe* (2019) and *Echoes of Integrity*, all portrays the abuse male (whether child or adult male) go through and the effect it poses on them as male adults. The movie *Penance* and *Brown Skin Girls* share similarities in types of abuse Oliver and Orman went through which is sexual abuse. Like Oliver in *Penance* who ignorantly enjoys the period of abuse from ages 10-13 years sees sexual abuse as being in love or in a romantic relationship with their maid which is far way older than him, Orman on the other hand in *Brown Skin Girl* didn't enjoy the period, even when he puts up a fight to stop the maid from abusing him, he was almost starved to death by her; as a result of an absentee parent who were never really at home, from 9-13 years was the period Orman was abused, thus this period turned out to be the worst period of his life unlike Oliver. In terms of the effect it had, it turns out differently. It is said that sexual abuse of children has both immediate and long-term effects on their wellbeing; this is actually true because the abusees were abused as children but see how long it affected them. This is a visible truth in the films, the effect of the abuse stayed with them from childhood into adulthood. When it comes to the different ways it affected them, Oliver on the other hand likes the nature of his abuser and craves to see her features in every older woman he meets, this kept him away from marriage because he couldn't find the exact feature of his abuser in any other woman. In the case of Orman, this was actually the opposite because he hated everything that looks like his abuser including dark skinned women. What happened much earlier in their childhood till has hold on them as adults. Again, in the case of Oliver, his parents were very observant to find the letter Oliver wrote to their maid expressing his love for her, which was inappropriate for a boy of his age, then they took action by sending the maid away unlike Orman whose parents where never around, probably, if they were, they would have paid more attention and averted the abuse Orman suffered. Both ways the abuse they faced affected them negatively.

In the film *Nimbe*, Nimbe as a young teenager was not faced with sexual abuse but was faced with the most common abuse like neglect, physical, emotional or psychological abuse, which led to a high level of both alcohol and drug usage and also murder due to the company he kept and the kind of environment he found himself was a contributing factor. Environmental factors had a toll on Nimbe unlike the other abusees, Oliver and Orman. Nimbe was exposed to a more crime filled environment than the others (Oliver and Orman). So, each time he feels like getting things off his mind, he will go smoking and drinking because of the kind of people he found himself associating with. It led to him murdering two persons in the film, one which was inspired by Ak the gang leader and Benji his classmate who is always bullying him, and this led him to life imprisonment.

In the area of damage, how have this abuse faced by Oliver, Orman and Nimbe turnout in their lives; meaning, to what extent did these abuse causes harm or damage to their lives. To Oliver and Orman, the effect of the abuse lasted more, from childhood to adulthood, but for some reason they found their way back. When it comes to Nimbe, his abuse was consistent from childhood to teenagerhood and at a time young adults reacts to changes in life, which is a delicate stage if not held properly at that age things will go wrong, you either have friends influence or youthful exorbitance. While Oliver's abuse lasted from age 10-13years, approximately 3 years Orman from 9-13 years which is 4 years; but Nimbe suffered consistency from child to about fifteen or sixteen years, because he was in SS2 class at the

time. To Oliver and Orman the damage of abuse did not cause them their lives, while to Nimbe it did, because in the end he faced life imprisonment for the choices he is forced to make as a victim of abuse.

In *Echoes of Integrity*, Chiora unlike Oliver, Orman and Nimbe didn't face abuse from childhood rather as a grown adult, who is married for 18 years; This is to show that one can be abused at any age or stage in life. The effect of abuse when it comes to Chiora lasted throughout period he was unemployed, Chiora faced abuse as a matured male adult while Oliver, Orman and Nimbe have theirs lasting longer because they were children who had no idea on what to do.

Summary and Conclusion

This study examined male abuse in selected Nollywood films, using Stephen Biodun's *Penance* (2020), Emeka Dibia Emelobe's *Brown Skin Girl* (2020), Tope Alake's *Nimbe* (2019) and Ugezu .J. Ugezu's *Echoes of Integrity* (2024) to showcase the effect abuse can have on a male child\adult. Male can experience the same types and tactics of abuse as women, such as stalking, harassment, physical, verbal, psychological and sexual abuse. However, the way male face or perceive abuse can be different. For example, male may believe that physical abuse is not an effective control tactic because they still feel powerful and physically able to stop the abuse.

Psychological abuse, which is one of the most common forms of domestic violence experienced by male, usually targets a man's masculinity. Male are usually accused of not being 'manly' enough, not making enough money, being weak or crying when abused. The critical literature review reports that why most men may not fear physical violence, they may fear the degradation and humiliation that comes from psychological abuse, especially in public. However, males are often reluctant to report abuse, because they feel embarrassed, fear that they won't be believed or are scared of what the outcome would be, or in other cases are scared that their partner would take revenge.

In conclusion, male abuse poses a lot of threat to the male folks, treating someone with violence, disrespect, cruelty, harm or force can be psychologically or emotionally draining. Males who experience abuse often suffer from severe emotional and psychological consequences, including anxiety, depression and post-traumatic stress disorder (PTSD). The trauma of being abused can lead to feelings of worthlessness, low self-esteem and even suicidal thought.

Domestic abuse affects people regardless of their gender, age or sexual orientation, yet, the experience of male victims is often overlooked and underreported. While domestic abuse is commonly associated with women as victims and men as perpetrators, male victims-survivors of domestic abuse face unique challenges such as societal stigma, a lack of support services and a heightened sense of shame and isolation.

Societal stigma and gender norms: one of the primary reasons for the underreporting of the domestic abuse among men is societal stigma. Traditional gender norms often dictate that men should be strong, stoic and able to protect themselves and their families. These expectations can make it difficult for to acknowledge that they are experiencing abuse, let alone seek help. The notion of male victims-survivors of abuse often clashes with cultural stereotype that portrays men as dominant and women as vulnerable. Male victims may also fear being labelled weak,

'unmanly' or even less of a man if they disclose their experiences of abuse. This fear of social judgement can cause them to hide the suffering, endure abuse in silence or even blame themselves. For many, it takes a great deal of courage to come forward and admit that they are victims of domestic abuse, and this can result in prolonged psychological and emotional harm. In addition to emotional distress, physical injuries are also common in male victim-survivors of domestic abuse. While men may be less likely to report physical injuries from domestic violence, it is important to recognize that abuse can take many forms.

Some men may face long term health problems stemming from chronic stress or untreated injuries as a result of abuse. Furthermore, the impact of domestic abuse on men can extend beyond the individual to their families and relationships. Male victims-survivors may find it difficult to maintain healthy relationships in the future due to the trauma they've experienced. The abuse can also affect their ability to care for their children particularly if they fear that their children will be taken away or that their parenting skills will be questioned due to their experience of abuse. While there is growing awareness of domestic abuse, support services remain primarily focused on female victim-survivors, this lack of accessible service leaves many males to face their abuse alone. This lack of support systems can lead to further isolation and suffering for male victims.

Recommendations

In suspected cases of child abuse at the hand of a parent or a caregiver, this treatment should be reported to child protection services or other relevant law enforcement agencies. Children that have been physically abused should then be stabilized with examinations carried out to determine the extent of the ill-treatment endured. Physical, emotional and sexual victims as well as children that have lived through neglect, need appropriate care. The children may be protected using treatment like psychotherapy, medication or a combination of both.

Therapy is useful for addressing the issues linked with abuse and neglect. It is also necessary to teach a child the appropriate behaviour for adult-child relationships. Therapy can also provide a support system for poorly treated children. Medication may be recommended for the PTSD, anxiety, depression, and other pains associated with abusive treatment.

Protecting yourself as an abused male: Domestic violence and abuse can have a serious physical and psychological impact. The first to protecting yourself and stopping the abuse is to reach out. Talk to a friend, family member, or someone you trust, or call a domestic violence helpline. Admitting the problem and seeking help doesn't mean you have failed as a man or as a husband. You are not to blame and you are not weak. As well as offering a sense of relief and providing some much-needed support, sharing details of your abuse can also be the first step in building a case against your abuser. Speaking to a licensed Therapist who can help with depression, anxiety, relationship and more.

Parent/caregiver and the society also realize the need to pay attended to the male child/adult in area of abuse. Parents should make out time not just for the female child alone, but also to create time to have intimate relationship or conversation with their male children to find out; (i) what they want (ii) what they are going through (iii) what drives them to do what they are doing (because some attitude in them may also be as a result of abuse) (iv) to encourage them to speak

out if they feel uncomfortable with any situation etc. You can take important steps to protect your child from exploitation and child abuse in your neighbourhood or community. The goal is to provide safe, stable, nurturing relationship with male children.

- Offer your male child love and attention: Nurture and listen to your child and be involved in your child's life to develop trust, and good communication. Encourage your child to tell you if there is a problem. A supportive family environment and social networks can help improve your child's feelings of self-esteem and self-worth.
- Don't respond in anger: If you feel overwhelmed or out of control, take a break. Don't take out your anger on your child. Talk with your health care provider or a therapist on how you can learn to cope with stress and interact better with your child.
- Think supervision: Don't leave a young child home alone. In public, keep a close eye on your child. Volunteer at school and for activities to get to know the adults who spend time with your child. When old enough to go out without supervision, encourage your child to stay away from strangers and hang out with friends rather than be alone. Make it a rule that your child tells you where he or she is at all times. Find out who is supervising your child for example, at a sleepover.
- Know your child's caregivers: check references for babysitters and other caregivers. Make irregular, but frequent unannounced visits to observe what's happening. Don't allow substitutes for your usual child care provider if you don't know the substitute.
- Emphasize when to say 'no': make sure your child understands that he or she doesn't have to do anything that seems scary or uncomfortable. Encourage your child to leave a threatening or frightening situation immediately and seek help from a trusted adult. If something happens, encourage your child to talk to you or another trusted adult about what happened. Assure your child that it's okay to talk and that he or she wouldn't get into trouble.
- Teach your child how to stay safe online: put the computer in a common area of your home, not the child's bedroom. Use the parental controls to restrict the types of websites your child can visit. Check your child's privacy settings or social networking sites. Consider it a red flag if your child is secretive about online activities. Cover online ground rules such as not sharing personal information; not responding to inappropriate, hurtful or frightening messages, and not arranging to meet an online contact in person without your permission. Tell your child to let you know if an unknown person makes contact through a social networking site. Reporting online harassment or inappropriate senders to your service provider and local authorities if necessary.
- Reach out: meet the families in your neighbourhood, including parents and children. Develop a network of supportive family and friends. If a friend or neighbour seems to be struggling, offer to babysit or help in another way. Consider joining a parent support group so that you have an appropriate place to vent your frustrations.

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Filmography

Penance (2020)

Producer: Biodoun Stephen

Director: Biodoun Stephen

Screenwriter: Mannie Oiseomaye

Stars: Wole Ojo, Blessing Onwukwe, Mike Afolarin, Bolaji Ogunwole

Brown Skin Girl (2020)

Producer: Emem Isong Misodi

Director: Emeka Dibia Emelobe

Screenwriter: Ukeme Nineday

Stars: Ik Ogbonna, Sophia Alakija, Kelvin Brovilertte, Ekamma Etim-Inyang, Chiamaka Gift, Fontaine Bassey

Nimbe (2019)

Producer: Folarin Laosun & Oluwaseun Dania

Director: Tope Alake

Screenwriter: Moshood Yakubu Olawale and Ronke Abede

Wokoro Silver Nnenda, Iloma Nyenwemaduka Richard, Tekena Gsaper Mark

Stars: Odunlade Adekola, Toyin Abraham, Chimezie Imo, Kelechi Udegbe, Molawa Davis,
Doyin Abiola Ojewole Timilehin

Echoes of Integrity (2024)

Producer: Atuma Henry

Director: Ugezu J. Ugezu

Screenwriter: Jane Offeagu

Stars: Fredrick Leonard, Ola Daniels, Sedetar Saviour, Obulunne, Chinedu Young Joshua